

1. Quoting Anthropic

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-30T23:58:15+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/30/anthropic/#atom-everything>

We've received notice that the Department of Commerce has lifted export controls on Claude Fable 5 and Mythos 5. We'll begin restoring access tomorrow, and will share an update soon. ? Anthropic , on Twitter Tags: anthropic , claude , generative-ai , claude-mythos , ai , llms

2. Nano Banana 2 Lite

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-30T22:15:35+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/30/nano-banana-2-lite/#atom-everything>

Nano Banana 2 Lite Also known as Gemini 3.1 Flash Lite Image (gemini-3.1-flash-lite-image in their API), this is the "fastest and cheapest Gemini image model, engineered for velocity and scale". I used AI studio to run this prompt: Do a where's Waldo style image but it's where is the raccoon holding a ham radio I like that one better than the results I got from the other Nano Banana models when I tried this back in April. It spelled Forest Festival wrong in two different ways though. Via Hacker News Tags: google , ai , generative-ai , llms , gemini , text-to-image , llm-release , nano-banana

3. What's new in Claude Sonnet 5

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-30T21:23:02+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/30/claude-sonnet-5/#atom-everything>

What's new in Claude Sonnet 5 Claude Sonnet 5 came out this morning . I always head straight for the "what's new" developer docs because they tend to have more actionable information than the official announcement post. Anthropic say of Sonnet 5 that "its performance is close to that of Opus 4.8, but at lower prices". The system card helps explain how they were able to release the model without being blocked by the US government: Sonnet 5 is significantly less capable at cyber tasks than Mythos 5: its safeguards are thus similar to those we apply to Opus 4.7 and Opus 4.8 (models that are more capable than Sonnet 5 but much less capable than Mythos 5). Of note from the "what's new" API changes: Sampling parameters temperature , top_p , top_k are no longer supported. It has a 1 million token context window and 128,000 maximum output tokens. It features "the same set of tools and platform features as Claude Sonnet 4.6" Adaptive thinking is on by default, unless you specify "thinking": {type: "disabled"} . The pricing is the same as Sonnet 4.6: \$3/million input, \$15/million input, with an introductory discount to \$2/\$10 until 31st August. But... The model has a new tokenizer, where "T...

4. Gnome

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-30T20:54:32Z

Link: <https://lexfriedman.com/gnome/>

Gnome is a deceptively clever animated GIF app by Lex Friedman: The truest thing about animated GIFs is that they are a critical pillar of modern human communication, and yet getting one into a Slack message or an iMessage thread or an email reply usually requires opening a browser, navigating to a website, searching, right-clicking, copying, switching back, pasting, and apologizing for the delay. By then the moment has passed, and the joke is dead, and what was the point of any of this, really? Gnome lives in your Mac's menubar. You hit a keyboard shortcut. A little search window appears. You type what you're looking for ? weird al , shrug , nailed it , that's a paddlin? ? and a grid of GIFs appears. Click the one you want. It's now on your clipboard. Paste it wherever you were typing. Joke saved. World improved. That's really the whole app. It does exactly that, and it gets out of the way. No account. No sign-in. No newsletter. Just GIFs, faster. When Friedman launched Gnome last month , it was Mac-only. Since then he's already added an iOS version , and they sync/coordinate nicely. And if you have a local folder of GIFs, you can connect that to Gnome and it'll show results from...

5. Supreme Court Agrees to Review Apple's Petition Regarding Civil Contempt Finding in Apple v. Epic Games?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-30T20:12:08Z

Link: https://www.supremecourt.gov/orders/courtorders/063026zor_3f14.pdf

Speaking of the Supreme Court's end-of-term rulings, they today agreed to grant certiorari to Apple's petition from last month, ordering: APPLE INC. V. EPIC GAMES, INC. The petition for a writ of certiorari is granted limited to Question 1 presented by the petition. Question 1 regarded the civil contempt finding — basically, whether Apple could be held in contempt for violating the spirit of the injunction by charging a commission on external payments when the letter of the injunction said nothing forbidding commissions on payments. Question 2 raised by Apple regarded the scope of the injunction — arguing that even if the contempt finding were upheld, that it should apply only to Epic, not to all developers in the U.S. App Store. (I decided against mentioning it in my article last month, — The Fonts of the U.S. Federal Courts —, but in stark contrast to the handsomeness and dignity with which their decisions are typeset (in Century Schoolbook), the Court's daily orders are, inexplicably, set in Lucida Sans Typewriter.) —

6. Supreme Court Upholds Birthright Citizenship in 6-3 Decision

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-30T19:40:38Z

Link: <https://talkingpointsmemo.com/edblog/the-birthright-citizenship-decision-is-more-evidence-for-court-reform/sharetoken/e2bf9547-fa9b-468c-8af3-aa09e72ca698>

Josh Marshall, writing at TPM (gift link): As you've seen, the Supreme Court upheld the constitutionality of birthright citizenship by a 6 — or perhaps 5% — vote margin. See Kate Riga's report on the majority decision and Josh Kovensky's piece on the dissenters' goal of doing away with birthright citizenship. I repeat my point from yesterday which is that the occasional non-corrupt decision doesn't make the Court any less corrupt or in need of reform. In this case, in a sane world, the dissents from Neil Gorsuch, Samuel Alito and Clarence Thomas would on their own be sufficient basis for impeachment and removal from office. One might as well believe or pretend to believe that the federal senate is unconstitutional despite its being unambiguously written into the structure of the document itself. The level of abuse of power that is the basis of these dissents can only be seen as criminal in nature and grows from the culture of corruption and impunity that now reigns on the Court. The 14th Amendment starts : All persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of the United States and of the State wherein they reside. The idea t...

7. A compatibility note on the abuse of Windows window class extra bytes

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260630-00/?p=112488>

Finding an illicit place to hide data. The post A compatibility note on the abuse of Windows window class extra bytes appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. The evolution of window and class extra bytes in Windows

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 29 Jun 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260629-00/?p=112484>

The intended usage is encoded in the prefix. The post The evolution of window and class extra bytes in Windows appeared first on The Old New Thing .

9. The Dating App Plot Device

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 07:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/dating-plot-device>

I've always been interested in how dating apps work. You really only have two choices if you want to get in the business. Help people find a match, and they will never come back Make people pay and keep them on the platform as long as possible. Let's pretend for a second that we actually want people to find love. Love is such a weird thing that we don't even know how to

define it properly. Ask two people what it means, and you will get five plausible definitions. If you approach it programmatically, then you will likely look into some measurable metrics to match people and then hope that love emerges somehow. In my quest to find what the ideal dating app would look like, I interviewed a couple of my friends that use those apps. I quickly gave up when I realized that I don't have a clue on how people actually use the apps. The first comment that threw me off was when my single friend told me of an app where she found some pretty good dates. How can you find some good dates and remain single? And what made them good? The more questions I asked, the less I understood. I guess I got lucky. I used a dating app for a brief time, and before I knew it I was married. I never got to experie...

10. DNA Sequence Alignment and Kings

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 01 Jul 2026 00:21:21 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/30/dna-sequence-alignment-and-kings/>

This morning I wrote a post that included the central Delannoy numbers. The n th central Delannoy number D_n counts the number of ways a king can move from one corner of a chessboard to the diagonally opposite corner without backtracking. The more general Delannoy numbers $D_{m,n}$ are the analogy for an $m \times n$ rectangular board, not [?] The post DNA Sequence Alignment and Kings first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Distinguishing variables from parameters

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 18:51:36 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/30/variables-and-parameters/>

Imagine the following dialog. Professor: f is a function of a real variable x that takes a real parameter k . Student: What's a parameter? Professor: It's a constant that can vary. Student: Then if it can vary, isn't it a variable? Professor: Sorta, but no not really. This conversation plays out over and over, and unfortunately it often [?] The post Distinguishing variables from parameters first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Silver Rectangles and the Ways of Kings

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 14:36:14 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/06/30/silver-kings/>

Golden rectangles The defining property of golden rectangle is that if you stick a square on its longer side, you get another golden rectangle. The smaller vertical rectangle is similar to the larger horizontal rectangle. This means $\phi / 1 = (1 + \phi) / \phi$ which tells us $\phi^2 = 1 + \phi$ and [?] The post Silver Rectangles and the Ways of Kings first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. As expected, using kexec to switch to a new Ubuntu kernel works

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-30T03:12:23Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/linux/UbuntuKexecRestartWorks>

For a long time, I ignored kexec both for my own personal machines and at work . I knew it existed but I never attempted to use it. That changed recently when I realized we could use kexec to start a network (re)install environment without needing our servers to actually have network booting enabled (which they mostly don't currently, for historical reasons). This has led me to do some additional experimentation with kexec . The most recent experiment was updating to a new Ubuntu kernel and then using ' kexec ' to switch to it instead of ' reboot '. On Ubuntu, this can be pretty simple due to some short symlinks, more or less: `kexec -l /boot/vmlinuz --initrd /boot/initrd.img --append "$(cat /proc/cmdline)" systemctl kexec` But I'm not sure we're going to actually use this in anything except very unusual circumstances. The good side of using kexec instead of reboot is that you don't have to sit through your BIOS slowly fiddling around with hardware and then GRUB doing GRUB things. This gets your system back on the air anywhere between 'somewhat faster' and 'much faster', depending on how slow your BIOS firmware is (and also your GRUB timeout). Some of our servers have firmware that...

14. Book Review: Fake Creativity by Blake Loch ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 11:34:20 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/06/book-review-fake-creativity-by-blake-loch/>

Thanks to BookSirens for providing me with a review copy. This is an intriguing self-published novel with a backstory almost as interesting as the plot. The story is a descent into paranoia as an author is convinced that an AI is plagiarising his work. As the madness takes over, he's forced to confront whether his creative processes are genuine or not. It raises some excellent questions about ?

15. Notes from June 2026

Source: Evan Hahn (dot com) | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://evanhahn.com/notes-from-june-2026/>

Chicago's weather is pretty lousy most of the year, but when it's nice, it's very nice. June blessed the city with dozens of idyllic days. But don't worry?I still spent most of the time inside on the computer. Things I did I launched my first big project at Ghost: automations ! It's still in beta, but it's one of the biggest projects I've led. If you happen to be a Ghost publisher, please try it out and let me know what you think! For the sixteenth issue of the Taper online magazine, I visualized time by breaking each unit into sixteenths . For example, as I write this, I'm about 6 sixteenths through the hour. Like every Taper submission, my work had to be under 2048 bytes. Links about AI ethics Generative AI continues to, mostly, be a force for bad in this world: ?If AI is going to 10x our productivity across the board, that means that I should be able to produce the same amount of output by midday on Monday that, in the before times, would have taken all week. So can I just take Friday off?? From ?Can we have the day off?? . ?AI's PR Problem? has a partial, but scathing, enumeration of many of the problems caused by generative AI. Useful as a reference. New AI resistance strateg...

16. Taking Roads and Bridges literally

Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-06-30T10:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://nesbitt.io/2026/06/30/taking-roads-and-bridges-literally.html>

I spent last week at UN Open Source Week , where officials from a dozen governments stood up in turn and described open source as critical infrastructure. That framing has been the standard one since Nadia Eghbal's Roads and Bridges report for the Ford Foundation in 2016, and after ten years it has finally reached the audience it describes. Sitting in a UN conference room full of people whose job is public infrastructure, I started wondering what it would mean to stop treating the title as a metaphor and look at how bridges are actually maintained. Roads and Bridges was pitched at the audience that was listening in 2016, technology companies and philanthropic foundations, neither of which maintains bridges: they drive over them for free, pay for them through tax, and leave the upkeep to the state. Spelling out the National Bridge Inspection Standards and the Highway Trust Fund to that room would have meant describing a government programme to a non-government audience, so the report stopped at the analogy and asked the people present to help. The decade since produced GitHub Sponsors, Open Collective, corporate OSPO budgets, and foundation grants: voluntary contributions from user...

17. Writing an LLM from scratch, part 34a -- building a JAX training loop for an LLM training run

Source: Giles' blog | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 19:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://www.gilesthomas.com/2026/06/llm-from-scratch-34a-building-a-jax-training-loop-for-an-llm-training-run>

For over a year, I've been using Sebastian Raschka's book " Build a Large Language Model (from Scratch) " -- and the multitude of side-projects that have branched out from reading it -- as something like a curriculum for learning about modern AI. The one final task I had set myself was to build and train an LLM from scratch just using my notes -- no reference to the book, no reference to the model code I'd written following the book. As an output, I wanted something as good as my best PyTorch model based on Raschka's code -- a base model, trained on 3.2B tokens, that my (admittedly limited) evals ranked as being close to the original GPT-2 small's quality. I wanted to use a different framework, just to make sure I wasn't parroting code that I'd somehow memorised, so I asked people on Twitter which one I should use, and the winner was JAX

. I took a slightly different route to Raschka's book; he takes an inside-out perspective, explaining things like attention, gradually building up a complete GPT-2-style model, and then building a training loop on top of it. I wanted to go outside-in: I'd put together a training harness to train the simplest-possible model with an API similar to...

18. Data-directed programming in Haskell (SICP 2.4.3)

Source: Entropic Thoughts | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0200

Link: <https://entropicthoughts.com/sicp-2-4-data-directed-programming-in-haskell>

I have a copy of SICP, or as it is also known, The Wizard Book . This book is widely praised, but I can't take the time to work my way through all of it. Instead, I'm going to occasionally jump into the parts of it that look interesting. Last week, we looked at tagged data in Haskell. The authors of SICP weren't convinced that's the best approach, so they move on to data-directed programming. We'll do the same. Complex numbers can be stored in their rectangular form, with a real and an imaginary part. They can also be stored in polar form, where there's a magnitude and an angle. Whichever way a complex number is stored, we would like to be able to query it for all of these four quantities: The real coordinate in the rectangular form of the complex number. The imaginary coordinate in the rectangular form. The magnitude in the polar form. The angle in the polar form. (Continue reading the full article on the web.)

19. The AI Industry Is Losing

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 15:36:38 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/the-ai-industry-is-losing/>

If you liked this piece, you should subscribe to my premium newsletter. It's \$70 a year, or \$7 a month, and in return you get a weekly newsletter that's usually anywhere from 5,000 to 18,000 words, including vast, detailed analyses of NVIDIA , Anthropic and

20. Grant Sanderson ? AI and the future of math

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 15:53:19 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/grant-sanderson-2>

Watch now (94 mins) | Math is where we'll see superintelligence first. What will it look like?

21. Pluralistic: Jo Walton's "Everybody's Perfect" (30 Jun 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 11:22:50 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/30/serenissima/>

Today's links Jo Walton's "Everybody's Perfect": A mystical tour-de-force that makes you feel like your mundane life until this point has all been a boring dream. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Corruption; How much (little) are the AI companies making? Upcoming appearances: London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Jo Walton's "Everybody's Perfect" (permalink) There's a new Jo Walton book, called Everybody's Perfect. Because it's a Jo Walton novel, you know in advance that three things are true about it: It is beautiful; It is profound; It is unlike every other novel, including every other Jo Walton novel. <https://us.macmillan.com/books/9781250314055/everybodysperfect/> Now, just because it's not like any other Jo Walton novel, that doesn't mean that it's not recognizably in a lineage of Walton's work, especially Walton's recent novels, which reflect an amazingly fruitful deep friendship and artistic relationship with the brilliant novelist and historian Ada P...

22. Weekly Update 510: Live From Mallorca with Scott Helme

Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Tue, 30 Jun 2026 15:42:54 GMT

Link: <https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-510/>

How's the view?! Back to business, it's now 8 years ago that Scott and I thought it would be a cool idea to build Why no HTTPS? We used the site to shame companies for not implementing their transport layer security property, and to make it

